

Propositions
accompanying the thesis
They grow up so fast
Stellar accretion in a starburst cluster

1. The average star in the Milky Way formed in a clustered environment with a strong UV radiation field, thousands of stellar neighbours, and high interstellar gas and dust density.
2. The majority of detailed observations related to star and planet formation focus on nearby low-mass star forming regions, which lack the strong environmental factors found in clusters.
3. The paradigms of star and planet formation that have developed from primarily low-mass star forming regions miss key, external, environmental influences.
4. When observed with the proper diagnostics, stars in clusters show systematically higher accretion rates and longer disk lifetimes compared to similar stars in low-mass star forming regions.
5. A proper accounting of environmental influences such as external photoevaporation and late-stage accretion could lead to fundamental revisions of star and planet formation.
6. Multi-object spectroscopy with the NIRSpec MSA is the most efficient observing mode offered by JWST. It provided me with a four year PhD from four hours of observations.
7. From proposing for observations to applying for jobs, there is a frustrating amount of random luck involved in what can make or break one's career.
8. Giving a talk at a conference is a privilege. Going exorbitantly over time is disrespectful.
9. Remote working is a blessing. Remote conferences are a curse.
10. No concept in astronomy has ever confused me more than basic Dutch grammar.
11. The reason for the recent under-performance of the Hollywood box-office is not Covid-19 or the Writer's Guild strike, but the vacuum created by the collapse of the MCU, and shrinking international markets due to geopolitical tension.

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